EXPERIMENT 11

Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

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Subject: Low Code Application Development using Zoho Creator

Aim

To demonstrate the development-to-production deployment workflow of a Zoho Creator application using the Environments feature, and to manage a multi-stage pipeline of isolated sandboxes (Development, Stage and Production) so that changes are built, tested and released in a controlled manner.

Introduction to Multi-Stage Deployment

Zoho Creator provides an Environments feature, described on its page as a multi-stage deployment space to test and publish an application without affecting the production. Each environment is a separate, isolated copy of the application with its own forms, reports, workflows and data. A change made in one environment does not reach the next until it is deliberately deployed. An application passes through three environments:

Environment	Purpose
Development	The sandbox in which the application is built, configured and changed. Changes made here do not reach end users.
Stage	An intermediate testing environment in which the release candidate is deployed, tested and approved before release.
Production	The live environment in which the tested application is published and used by end users.

Figure 11.0: Multi-Stage Deployment Pipeline (Conceptual Diagram)

Why isolated workspaces matter

Because the three environments are isolated, unfinished or unverified work cannot disturb the live application. Structural changes such as new fields, altered validation, rewritten workflows or changed permissions are first made in Development, where a failure affects only the developer. The change is promoted to Stage, where it is tested without touching real requesters or records, and published to Production only after approval. For EcoCycle this protects the live e-waste records, collection requests and recycling status from broken forms, lost entries and unverified changes to the priority rules, and every release stays controlled and traceable through Version History.

Application Used

EcoCycle – E-Waste Collection & Recycling Management: a Zoho Creator application that records e-waste, manages collection requests and tracks recycling. At the time of the project report it existed as a single application instance on a trial account; development, stage and production environments had not been used, so this experiment studies the Environments feature and the intended release path for EcoCycle.

Procedure

The deployment follows the flow: Development Environment → Stage Environment → Production Environment.

Note: Figures 11.1 and 11.2 are to be screenshots from your own Zoho Creator account. Figures 11.3 and 11.4 are illustrative views that show the stages of the deployment workflow; they are not captures of a completed deployment, and the statuses shown in them are for illustration only.

1. Sign in to Zoho Creator. The home page lists the applications, including EcoCycle. The left panel is divided into DEVELOP, DEPLOY and MANAGE; the DEPLOY group contains Environments, Mobile and Portal. Environments is used for deploying applications across environments.

[Paste your own screenshot here]

Zoho Creator home with EcoCycle and the DEPLOY → Environments option highlighted

Figure 11.1: Zoho Creator Home – EcoCycle Application and the DEPLOY → Environments Option

2. Select **Environments** under DEPLOY. The page describes a multi-stage deployment space to test and publish applications without affecting the production, and offers Version History, Manage and Publish at the top. The Stage and Production environments appear as separate columns, with the applications listed on the left.

[Paste your own screenshot here]

Environments page with EcoCycle listed and the Stage and Production columns

Figure 11.2: Environments Page – EcoCycle Listed with the Stage and Production Columns

3. If the application is not listed, select **Add Application** and add EcoCycle to the environment. Once it is published, version 1.0 appears under Stage and Production and the status changes to “No changes available” (Figure 11.3).

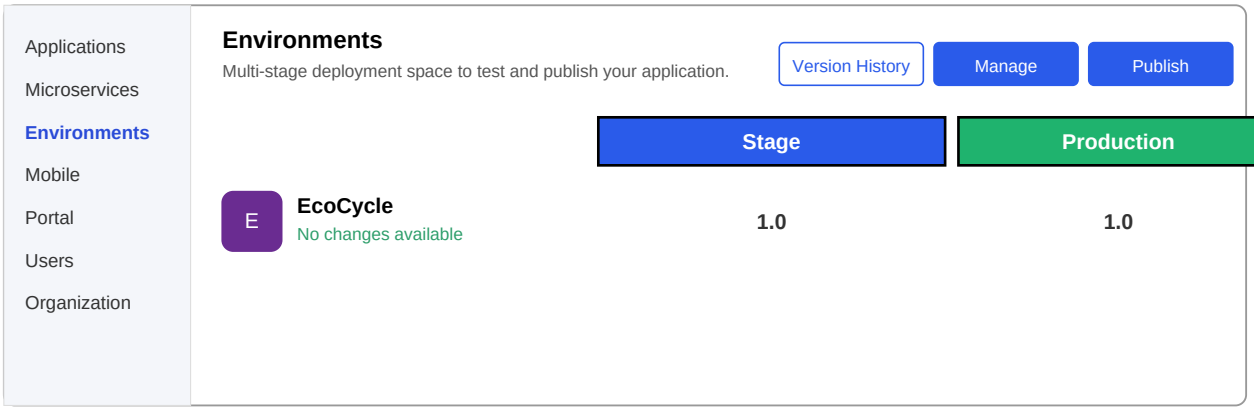

Figure 11.3: Environments Page – Application with Version 1.0 in Stage and Production (Illustrative)

4. **Development environment:** EcoCycle is built and configured here, with its forms, reports, dashboard and workflows. Status: Deployed – "Application configured and ready for deployment".
5. **Stage environment:** EcoCycle is deployed to Stage, where the priority calculation, the past-date check, the reports and the dashboard are tested and approved. Status: Deployed – "Application tested and approved in Stage".
6. **Production environment:** after approval in Stage, EcoCycle is published to Production. The status is Live and the Deployment Progress panel shows Production as Live – "Application is live and accessible to end users" (Figure 11.4).

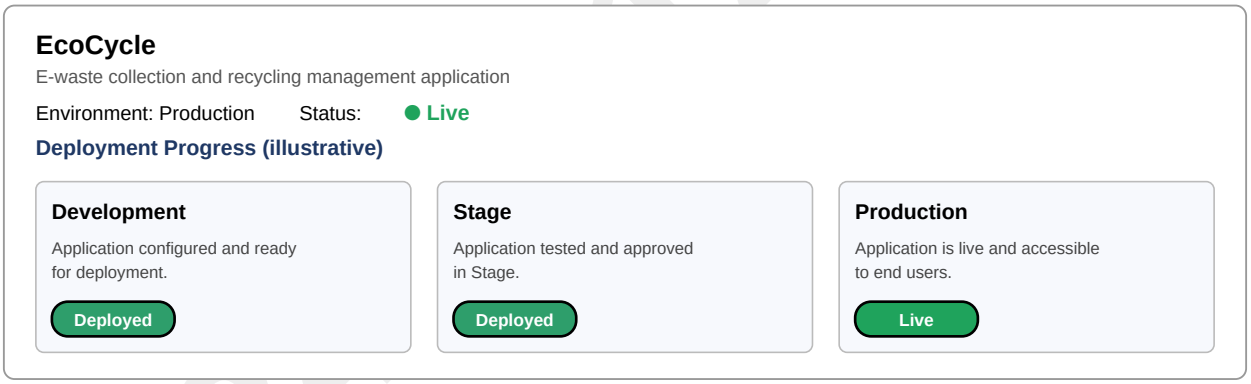

Figure 11.4: Deployment Progress – EcoCycle Live in Production (Illustrative)

Infrastructure Timeline

The progression of EcoCycle from build to production rollout, as shown in the Deployment Progress illustration, is summarised below. The statuses are illustrative.

Stage	Environment	Status	Description Shown
1	Development	Deployed	Application configured and ready for deployment.
2	Stage	Deployed	Application tested and approved in Stage.
3	Production	Live	Application is live and accessible to end users.

Result

The following were carried out for the EcoCycle application:

- The Environments page under DEPLOY was accessed and the Stage and Production environments were studied.

- EcoCycle was seen listed in the environment with the Stage and Production columns, ready to be published.
- The development-to-production flow (Development → Stage → Production) was demonstrated through illustrative views, including version 1.0 in Stage and Production and the Deployment Progress panel with Production shown as Live.

Conclusion

The experiment explained how a Zoho Creator application moves from development to production through environments. EcoCycle is configured in Development, deployed to Stage where its priority scoring, validation, reports and dashboard are tested and approved, and then published to Production, where requesters and staff can use it. This staged approach gives isolation of work in progress, verification before release, a controlled and traceable promotion path and Version History for review, and it keeps live e-waste records protected from untested changes. At present EcoCycle remains a single trial-account instance; moving it through the three environments is the next deployment step.

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